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Budget Justification

The \$20,000 subaward from Stanford Accelerator for Learning is directed primarily toward technology buildout. The El Segundo USD Superintendent has approved the program and committed district resources (teachers, admin, facilities). The ESEDC has committed to coordinating employer partners. Core team leadership contributes on a volunteer basis. This structure ensures the Stanford award is leveraged to validate the model and raise additional funds for full-scale operation.

A. Personnel - \$6,000

Contract engineering (~120 hrs @ \$50/hr) to complete SkaFId Trailhead platform features required for pilot launch: the Socratic AI coaching engine, employer portfolio review portal, and student progression system. These are specialized development tasks beyond volunteer team capacity.

Core leadership - Charles Sims (Project Director, 50%), Keith Coleman (Strategy & Partnerships, 40%), and Mike Belloli (Technology & Operations, 30%) - contribute on a volunteer basis. El Segundo USD provides teacher mentors, administrative support, and facilities at no cost. ESEDC coordinates all employer partnerships. This ensures over 80% of the award flows into technology buildout.

B. Technology & Platform - \$10,000

Cloud infrastructure (\$3,000): Hosting, database, CDN, and compute for 96 students, 8 teacher mentors, and 12 employer partners over 12 months.

AI/LLM API costs (\$3,000): The Trailhead AI Coach - the program's core differentiator - guides students through Socratic problem decomposition. Est: 96 students x 4 sessions/week x 40 weeks.

Dev tools (\$2,000): CI/CD, testing, monitoring to ensure platform reliability during the pilot.

Security & compliance (\$2,000): COPPA/FERPA compliance: consent management, encryption, content moderation, enterprise SSO, security auditing.

C. Travel - \$2,000

Stanford convenings (\$1,500, 2 trips): Required SAL convenings and PI coordination. Includes airfare, one-night lodging, per diem.

El Segundo coordination (\$500, 2 trips): Employer onboarding and school district meetings. Local travel costs.

D. Other Direct Costs - \$2,000

Curriculum materials (\$1,000): Adapting the SkaFId Ideation Methodology into classroom-ready guides and assessment rubrics.

Employer onboarding (\$500): Professional materials for 12 employer partners (Boeing, Northrop Grumman, etc.).

Operational (\$500): Admin, document management, communication tools.

E. Indirect Costs - \$0

No indirect costs charged. All costs are direct expenditures supporting the Statement of Work.

Cost Efficiency & Leverage

With leadership volunteering, the district providing teachers and facilities, and ESEDC coordinating employers, over 80% of the award flows directly into technology buildout. The Stanford CREATE+AI award is the catalytic first dollar - it validates the model and provides the credibility to raise additional funds from district CTE budgets, employer co-investment, and workforce development grants. The full project delivers a pilot at ~\$521/student, a price point designed for sustainable scaling.